CHAPTER 5

Panchayats and Rural Development

1. PANCHAYATS

Achievements

- 11 Plastic Shredders, in each taluka has been provided on experimental basis and the progress of the utilization of these shredders is being monitored for taking further action in the matter.
- Computerization of all the Village Panchayats has been completed and 189 Village Panchayats have been provided with Computers under Infogram Scheme.
- In order to tackle the garbage problem in the Village Panchayats, the department is implementing the "Goa Rural Garbage Scheme 2005".134 Village Panchayats have identified the land site for collection and treatment of the garbage. Further, 75 proposals have been cleared by the Goa Pollution Control Board and the same are being processed for land acquisition purpose.
- The Village Panchayats are duty bound to impound stray cattle in the Village Panchayat areas under the Goa Panchayats Raj Act, 1994. All the Village Panchayats have established temporary cattle pounds and some of them have also appointed temporary Pound keepers for impounding the stray cattle. A proposal for outsourcing this job to private agency in the Village Panchayats has also been moved to the Government for approval.

Initiatives

- The Directorate of Panchayats has initiated measures in the Village Panchayats for attaining responsive Governance and working towards good governance. Some of the steps taken in this direction are to set up citizen friendly Reception Counter and Waiting Room in the Panchayats, finalizing timelines for all citizen related services, putting up signages at all required places, setting up of complaints box, making available of updated information on status of all complaints/grievances, etc.
- New Accounting formats prescribed by the Comptroller & Audit General for the Village Panchayats and Zilla Panchayats have been incorporated in the Rules of Accounting procedure. The same are in the process of publication and will be

implemented from the year 2008-09.

- The Village Panchayats are authorized to collect various taxes and fees under the Goa Panchayat Raj Act, 1994. The State Government provides the necessary support through grants-in-aid to the Village Panchayats for strengthening and building their capacity by way of infrastructure support, staff salaries, etc. The Village Panchayats are encouraged to step up the mobilization of their own resources. The department is continuously monitoring the resource mobilization by the Village Panchayats through inspection and issue of various directions from time to time.

2. RURAL DEVELOPMENT AGENCY

The Rural Development Agency was set up in November 1980 after amalgamating Small Farmers Development Agency and Integrated Rural Development Programme. After Goa attained statehood on 30th May 1987, the territories of Daman & Diu were delinked and the agency restricted its activity to Goa only. In the year 1996-97, a separate branch office of RDA was set up in Margao South Goa district. From the year 2001, two independent district offices are functioning in the respective revenue districts.

a. Swabhiman

The scheme "SWABHIMAN" (self respect) is launched for women, the mentally and physically disabled and senior citizens to enable them to be independent and earn a regular, decent income. It is tentatively proposed to follow the following modalities by taking a leaf from the success stories of similar initiatives like Amul doing a Pilot Project in Andhra Pradesh with rehabilitated sex workers and Lijjat Papad, etc. where the entire co-operative movement is undergoing a radical change as concepts of professionalism and private marketing techniques and gradually being incorporated.

To set up a Women's Development Corporation to manage the initiative, the Corporation will set up collectives of women, disabled persons and senior citizens which could be SHGs, Mahila Mandals, Corporatives, etc. It will handle aspects like training programmes, quality control and marketing of the products, loans and subsidies, tie up with major companies or industries who would provide the raw material and then purchase the end products.

It is proposed that this initiative be collaborative efforts of the Departments of Rural Development. For successful implementation of the scheme, it will be entrusted to the Anganwadi workers, the Mukhya Sevikas and CDPOs of the Department of Women and Child Development. It is proposed to cover one lakh women, around 10,000 Senior Citizens and around 10,000 disabled persons. Each Anganwadi worker would therefore need to interact with only 120 people or 3-4 groups which is a fairly manageable task. Attempts will be made to keep the liability of the State

government to the very minimum. Wherever possible, BPL families will also be included in this initiative with a view to eliminate rural poverty in Goa.

In order to finalize the modalities, a pilot scheme is started in Canacona and Valpoi and some Self Help Groups have already been formed. The Department of Rural Development has initiated discussions at various levels to tune the modalities of the scheme.

b. Goa Grameen Urja Yojana (GGUY)

With an objective of achieving 0% poverty in both Rural and Urban areas, it is proposed to provide additional financial support to all the below poverty line families in the State within a period of 2 years. A new scheme Goa Grameen Urja Yojana (GGUY) is proposed to be implemented from the year 2007-08 under which Liquified Petroleum Gas (LPG) installation with gas stove of two burners and two cylinders will be provided to BPL families inorder to serve their primary need of cooking.

c. Goa Rural Employment Guarantee Scheme

The State of Goa has formed a scheme namely "Goa Rural Employment Guarantee Scheme" based on the National Rural Employment Guarantee Act.

The objective of the scheme is to provide for the enhancement of livelihood, security of the household in the rural areas in the State of Goa by providing at least 100 days of the guaranteed wages employment in a financial year to every household whose adult member volunteer to do unskilled manual work.

Any adult (18-60 years) who is residing in a rural household for more than 15 years and who is willing to do semi-skilled/unskilled manual labour at the minimum wage specified by the scheme will be entitled to apply for the same. It is not restricted to Below Poverty Line (BPL) families only. The household member should be a bonafide local resident of the area where he or she works.

Job Card is the most critical legal document for work entitlement and its guarantee. If a household applies for registration it is the duty of the Gram Panchayat to register it and issue a 'job card' within a week after registration. The job card will ensure that labourers are in possession of a written record of the number of days they have worked, wages paid, unemployment allowances received, and so on instead of depending on Government officials for this purpose. A person can apply for work only when he/she is registered.

The employment guarantee is restricted to 100 days per household per year under the scheme. The 'year' here refers to the financial year, which starts on 1st April. Each household gets a new 'Quota' of 100 days which can be 'shared' between adult

members of the household. Different persons can work on different days, or even on the same day, as long as their combined days of employment do not exceed 100 days of employment in the financial year. The scheme is implemented in the State w.e.f. 25/9/2006.

The Government of India will bear entire cost of the scheme, i.e. salaries of APOs, Engineers, Accountants, Computer Programmers, Gram Sevaks, Peons, etc. and also includes the expenditure required towards Publicity Material, Training and Awareness required for the scheme. The State Government has to bear 10% of the total cost of the scheme, i.e. unemployment allowances and State Council Meeting.

d. Integrated Waterland Development Programme (Hariyali)

Projects Sanctioned Under DRDA North

At the Tuem Watershed Development Project in Pernem, till date following watershed related works have been undertaken under DRDA North namely construction of 12 check dams, one Sunken pond at Amai-Bhutwadi, construction of 12 check dam, construction of Anganwadi House at Tuem-Deulwada and desilting of Ganesh Khond at Tuem-Deulwada and construction of 8 check dam at Virnoda.

Significant Achievements

- Under Swarnajayanti Gram Swarojgar Yojana (SGSY) scheme during the year 2007-08 (Upto November '07), 223 families have been assisted as against the target of 400 of North Goa District and 192 families have been assisted as against the target of 196 of South Goa District.
- There are 801 Self Help Groups formed since inception till March 2007.

Table 5.1 : Self Help Groups formed from 1999 to March 2007 districtwise

DRDA NORTH

Sl. No.	Name of the Block	Number of groups from 1999 to March 2006	Number of groups from April 2006 to March 2007	Total	No. of groups (loan sanctioned (2006-07)	
					No. of cases recommended to Bank	No. of groups loan sanctioned
1	Bardez	140	80	220	13	41
2	Bicholim	69	10	79	2	7
3	Ponda	97	16	113	16	6
4	Pernem	64	10	74	8	11
5	Sattari	70	3	73	5	5
6	Tiswadi	26	4	30	1	1
	Total	**466**	**123**	**589**	**46**	**44**

DRDA SOUTH

Sl. No.	Name of the Block	Number of groups from 1999 to March 2006	Number of groups from April 2006 to March 2007	Total	No. of groups (loan sanctioned (2006-07)	
					No. of cases recommended to Bank	No. of groups loan sanctioned
1	Sanguem	38	8	46	55	44
2	Quepem	69	9	78	62	62
3	Canacona	43	12	55	62	62
4	Salcete	26	3	29	85	83
5	Mormugao	4	--	4	9	7
	Total	180	32	212	273	258

Table 5.2 : Achievement of cases during 2006-07 districtwise

DRDA-NORTH

Sl. No.	Name of the Block	Target	Identified	Recommended	Sanctioned by bank	Pending in bank
1	Bardez	126	213	213	172	41
2	Bicholim	52	98	98	52	13
3	Ponda	77	90	90	52	39
4	Pernem	53	55	55	59	07
5	Sattari	75	86	86	80	16
6	Tiswadi	17	37	37	13	16
	Total	400	579	579	428	132

DRDA-SOUTH

Sl. No.	Name of the Block	Target	Identified	Recommended	Sanctioned by bank	Pending in bank
1	Sanguem	57	55	55	44	11
2	Quepem	37	62	62	74	2
3	Canacona	57	62	62	75	2
4	Salcete	61	90	85	83	7
5	Mormugao	06	9	9	7	2
6	Total	218	278	273	283	24

- Goa SARAS Exhibition was inaugurated on 22/12/2006. The Exhibition had 180 stalls and 192 Self Help Groups comprising of group beneficiaries from Andhra Pradesh, Assam, Bihar, Gujrat, Haryana, Jammu & Kashmir, Karnataka, Kerala, Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Orissa, Rajasthan, Tripura, Tamil Nadu, Uttar Pradesh, West Bengal, Jharkhand & Goa, participated in the exhibition.
- Under the Indira Awas Yojana (IAY), during the year 2006-07 in North Goa, 457 new constructions and 318 upgradation of the existing houses have been undertaken. In South Goa, 196 new constructions and 70 upgradations have been carried out. During the year 2007-08, 190 new constructions and 113 upgradations were carried out in North Goa. Similarly in South Goa, 101 new constructions and 62 upgradations were carried out.
- Under Credit cum Subsidy scheme during 2006-07, 60 and 14 families have been assisted in North and South Goa respectively. During 2007-08, 79 and 12 families have been assisted in North and South Goa respectively.
- Under National Old Age Pension scheme, 3409 beneficiaries covering all talukas have been assisted during the year 2006-07. The total number of beneficiaries during the year 2007-08 (upto October'07) are 2687.
- Under National Family Benefit scheme, 313 beneficiaries covering all talukas have been assisted during the year 2006-07. Talukawise analysis shows 58 persons (18%) from Bardez taluka followed by Sattari 53 persons (17%) and Salcete 39 persons (12%) have been assisted. The lowest number of beneficiaries is from Tiswadi taluka, 3 persons (1.9%). During the year 2007-08, 179 beneficiaries were covered.
- Under Balika Samruddhi Yojana (BSY), 83 girl children were assisted during 2006-07, of which 30 children (36%) are from Bardez taluka. The least to avail the assistance is from Ponda and Tiswadi talukas covering only 8 children. During the year 2007-08, the number of beneficiaries is only 44.

3. SETTLEMENT AND LAND RECORDS

New initiatives, to improve the service to the people

As the present office premise does not have sufficient space for its smooth functioning, a proposal has been forwarded to the Government for expansion of the office of the Supdt. of Surveys & Land Records, (South), Margao & City Survey, Mapusa. It is proposed to purchase the premises adjoining to the aforesaid offices after which the strength of the staff could also be increased to improve the service to the people.

The City Survey Office, Vasco has been shifted to a prime location and sufficient area has been provided. Considering the requirement of the proposed Sub-Divisional office for Mormugao taluka, a proposal for providing 150 sq.mts. area in the proposed

Government office complex at Vasco has been submitted to S.D.O. implementing authority. This will facilitate the public once all the offices come under one office complex.

Significant Achievements

- Computerization (scanning and digitization) of the old cadastral maps and documents of Portuguese regime is in progress and the same is expected to be completed by March 2008.
- Central Government granted approval for the project of integration of textual and graphical data.